

ALBERTA & BRITISH COLUMBIA

Canadian Rockies Road Trip

Calgary → Vancouver · Aug 18–27, 2026

4 BASE CAMPS

BASE 01

Canmore, AB

Aug 18 – 21

3 Nights

Gateway to Banff ·
Moraine Lake · Lake
Louise · Johnston
Canyon

BASE 02

Jasper, AB

Aug 21 – 23

2 Nights

Maligne Lake ·
Pyramid Lake ·
Jasper town · Dark
Sky Preserve

BASE 03

Revelstoke, BC

Aug 23 – 24

1 Night

Rogers Pass · Glacier
NP · Entry into British
Columbia

BASE 04

Whistler & Vancouver

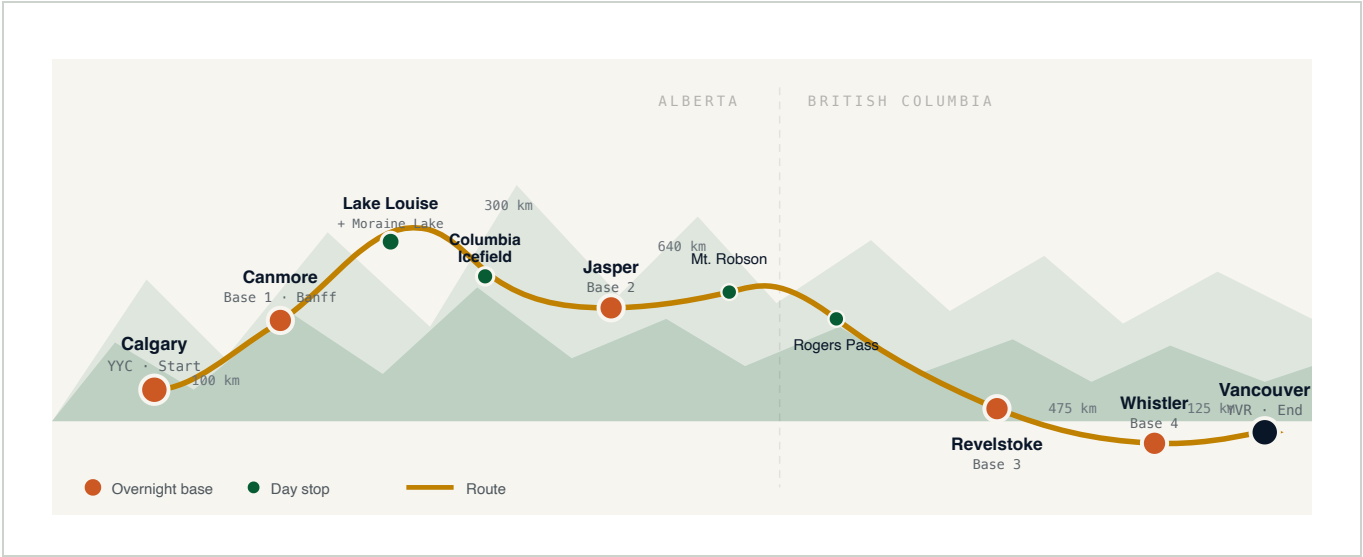
Aug 24 – 27

3 Nights

Peak 2 Peak ·
Garibaldi · Sea to Sky
Hwy · Fly out YVR

THE ROUTE

Calgary → Vancouver · ~1,640 km



DRIVING AT A GLANCE

LEG	KM	EST. TIME	HIGHWAY
Calgary YYC → Canmore	100 km	~1 hr	Trans-Canada Hwy 1 West
Canmore → Jasper (via Icefields Pkwy)	300 km	3.5 hr + stops	Hwy 1 W → Hwy 93 North
Jasper → Revelstoke	640 km	~6 hr	Hwy 16 W → Hwy 5 S → Hwy 1 E
Revelstoke → Whistler	475 km	~5 hr	Hwy 1 W → Cache Creek → Hwy 99 S
Whistler → Vancouver YVR	125 km	~2 hr	Sea to Sky Hwy 99 South
Total driving distance	~1,640 km	~17+ hr	Excludes day-trip mileage

DAY

1

SUNDAY, AUGUST 18, 2026

Calgary Arrival → Canmore

1 hr • 100 km • Trans-Canada Hwy 1 West

● Fly into Calgary YYC Morning

Collect luggage and pick up the SUV rental at YYC. Confirm your Pursuit Pass package and the one-way drop arrangement at YVR before leaving the counter.

● Grocery stop in Calgary ~30 min

Superstore or Walmart just off Hwy 1. Stock up on snacks, drinks, and breakfast items for the full trip — grocery options thin out once you're in the parks.

● Drive Trans-Canada to Canmore ~1 hr

Take Hwy 1 West through Cochrane. Watch for the moment the Rockies appear on the horizon — Three Sisters, Ha Ling Peak, and Mt. Rundle come into view near the park gate.

● Check into Airbnb + review bookings Afternoon

Unpack and settle in. Confirm Moraine Lake shuttle, Spirit Island boat tour, gondola time slots, and all four Airbnb check-in codes before the trip kicks into gear.

● Main Street Canmore walk + dinner Evening

Walk downtown Canmore — mountain views in every direction. Try Crazyweed Kitchen (modern cuisine) or The Grizzly Paw Brewing for a relaxed first evening.

BOOK BEFORE YOU GO

Moraine Lake shuttles fill weeks out — confirm your Parks Canada reservation now. Spirit Island boat tours (Day 5) require advance booking through SunDog Tours. Both sell out in August.

DAY

2

MONDAY, AUGUST 19, 2026

Banff National Park

Day trip from Canmore • 20 min • 25 km each way

● Banff Gondola — Sulphur Mountain Morning • Pursuit Pass

Ride to 2,281m summit. 360° views of six mountain ranges from the summit boardwalk. Walk to Sanson Peak weather observatory (15 min). Allow 2–2.5 hrs total including the ride.

● Banff Avenue + Bow Falls Midday

Stroll the main strip for lunch — Park Distillery and Eddie Burger + Bar are both good. Short path leads to Bow Falls viewpoint from Bow Avenue bridge.

● Lake Minnewanka Afternoon • 20 min from Banff

Largest lake in Banff National Park. Scenic drive along the shoreline. Optional: 1.5-hour boat cruise. The free lakeside viewpoint and picnic area is worth the detour alone.

● Johnston Canyon Late afternoon • 30 min from Canmore

Catwalk trail through a dramatic limestone canyon. Lower Falls: 1.1 km easy (30 min). Upper Falls add 2.7 km more (45 min extra). Go at least to the Upper Falls — they're worth it. Return before dark.

PARKS CANADA DISCOVERY PASS

Required for Banff NP entry. Buy online at parks.canada.ca or at the park gate. The group day pass (~\$10.50/person) is fine; the annual Discovery Pass (~\$75/adult) pays off if you plan to visit more parks this year. It also covers Jasper and Glacier NP later in this trip.

DAY

3

TUESDAY, AUGUST 20, 2026

Moraine Lake + Lake Louise

90 km from Canmore • ~1.5 hr

● Moraine Lake — Valley of Ten Peaks 5:00–5:30 AM departure

The glacier-carved valley backed by ten peaks above 3,000m. Climb the Rock Pile (easy, 20 min) for the classic viewpoint. Canoe rentals available from the dock. Take the Parks Canada shuttle from the Lake Louise Park & Ride.

● Lake Louise Midday • 15 min from Moraine

Walk the lakefront promenade to the far end for Victoria Glacier views. The Lake Agnes Tea House hike (7.4 km roundtrip, 600m gain, 3–4 hrs) is one of the finest moderate hikes in the Rockies — reward is tea, scones, and views at 2,135m.

● Return to Canmore, pack for tomorrow Afternoon

Day 4 is a drive day with an early checkout. Pack tonight. Dinner at home base.

MORAINE LAKE — THE MOST IMPORTANT LOGISTICS OF THE TRIP

You'll be taking the Parks Canada shuttle from the Lake Louise Park & Ride — the right call.

SHUTTLE PASSES DROP ON THE PARKS CANADA SITE 2 DAYS BEFORE YOUR VISIT AT 8:00 AM MT — SET AN ALARM, HAVE THE PAGE OPEN AHEAD OF TIME, AND BOOK WITHIN THE FIRST FEW MINUTES.

Slots vanish in seconds on August dates.

DAY

4

WEDNESDAY, AUGUST 21, 2026

Icefields Parkway → Jasper

300 km • ~3.5 hr driving + stops • Check out Canmore

● Bow Lake 1 hr 15 min from Canmore

First major stop on the Parkway. Glacier-fed water that's impossible to photograph badly. Easy lakeside trail (30 min). Bow Glacier visible at the far end.

● Peyto Lake — Bow Summit Lookout 20 min from Bow Lake

Park at Bow Summit (2,069m — highest paved point on the Pkwy). Walk 20 min to the famous wolf-head viewpoint over the electric-blue lake. Arrive before 10 AM for best colour and fewest people.

● Columbia Icefield + Glacier Skywalk Midday • Pursuit Pass

Walk onto 10,000-year-old Athabasca Glacier with a Parks Canada guide. Then cross the Glacier Skywalk — a glass-bottomed cliff walkway suspended 280m above Sunwapta Valley. Allow 2.5–3 hrs combined.

● Athabasca Falls 30 min south of Jasper

The Athabasca River forces through a narrow quartzite gorge, falling 23m with enormous force. Short paved loop takes 10 minutes. Thunderous even in late summer.

● Arrive Jasper, check in Late afternoon

Jasper is a small, walkable mountain town. Walk Connaught Drive. Elk frequently graze in town at dusk. Dinner at Marmot Bistro or Evil Dave's Grill.

DAY

5

THURSDAY, AUGUST 22, 2026

Jasper Area Exploration

Basecamp Jasper • Day trips up to 45 min

- **Maligne Lake — Spirit Island Cruise**

Morning • 45 min from Jasper • Book in advance

Drive past Medicine Lake (a "sinking" lake with no visible outlet — it drains underground). At Maligne Lake, board the 90-minute Spirit Island boat cruise — one of Canada's most iconic views. Kayak rentals available at the boathouse if cruise is sold out.

- **Maligne Canyon**

Midday • 15 min from Jasper

Six bridges cross a 55m limestone gorge carved by the Maligne River. The teahouse sits at trailhead. Full canyon loop: 7.5 km, 2–2.5 hrs. Short version to bridge 2: 45 min, very dramatic.

- **Pyramid Lake**

Afternoon • 8 km from Jasper

Mountain-ringed lake with an island connected by a footbridge. Paddle rentals, easy shoreline trail, excellent views of Pyramid Mountain. Low-key and beautiful.

- **Jasper town + stargazing**

Evening

Jasper is a designated Dark Sky Preserve — among the largest in the world. If skies are clear, drive a few kilometres out of town and look up. Pack up tonight for tomorrow's long drive to Revelstoke.

WILDLIFE IN JASPER

Elk walk through the townsite, especially at dusk. Bears are common on all side roads. Carry bear spray on every trail. Maintain 30m from elk and 100m from bears and other predators — the Parks Canada rule, and a good one.

DAY

6

FRIDAY, AUGUST 23, 2026

Jasper → Revelstoke

640 km • ~6 hr driving • Check out Jasper • Cross into BC

- **Early checkout, head west on Hwy 16** 7:30–8:00 AM departure

Yellowhead Highway through the Miette Valley. The drive west from Jasper is dramatic — wide valley, mountain walls on both sides, frequent wildlife sightings (mountain goats, moose).

- **Mt. Robson Provincial Park** ~1 hr from Jasper

At 3,954m, Mt. Robson is the highest peak in the Canadian Rockies. Stop at the visitor centre for the view — the summit is cloud-capped more than two-thirds of days. On a clear morning, it stops you cold.

- **Hwy 5 South through the Thompson Plateau** Midday drive • fuel in Kamloops

From Valemount, Hwy 5 drops south through interior BC — dry grassland and pine forest replace the alpine. Kamloops is the natural lunch and fuel stop (halfway point). Don't skip — petrol is sparse east of the city toward Revelstoke.

- **Rogers Pass — Glacier National Park** Late afternoon

The Trans-Canada's most dramatic mountain pass through the Selkirks. Rogers Pass Discovery Centre (National Historic Site) is worth 20 minutes. Concrete avalanche sheds line the highway — the world's largest mobile avalanche control program. Stunning Illecillewaet Glacier visible from the road.

- **Arrive Revelstoke** Evening

Revelstoke punches above its size — good food, craft beer, lively Mackenzie Ave. Try Dose Coffee in the morning. Check in and rest; tomorrow is another drive day.

THE LONG DAY — PLAN AROUND IT

640 km is the most demanding driving day of the trip. Depart by 7:30–8:00 AM to reach Revelstoke before 7 PM. The Mt. Robson and Rogers Pass stops are the natural breaks — don't skip them, but keep them to 20–30 min each.

DAYS

7–9

SATURDAY–MONDAY, AUGUST 24–26, 2026

Whistler

Revelstoke → Whistler: 475 km • ~5 hr via Hwy 1 W + Hwy 99

AUG 24 — DRIVE + ARRIVAL

AUG 25–26 — FULL DAYS IN WHISTLER

● Drive Revelstoke → Whistler

Morning • ~5 hr

Hwy 1 West to Cache Creek, then Hwy 99 South through Lillooet and Pemberton (Duffey Lake Road) — a spectacular mountain route in its own right. Arrive Whistler Village by early afternoon.

● Peak 2 Peak Gondola

Afternoon • Pursuit Pass

The world's longest unsupported gondola span (3 km, 436m above the valley). Connects Whistler and Blackcomb peaks at 2,182m. A glass-floored cabin runs on the hour. Take it first — it closes in the evening.

● Whistler Village + Alta Lake Evening

Walk the car-free pedestrian village. Alta Lake is a 10-min drive — kayak or SUP rentals, calm water, and mountain reflections. Good dinner on the Village Stroll.

● Garibaldi Lake Trail

Full day • 18 km rt • Strenuous

Best big hike of the trip. Volcanic-cinder slopes open onto one of BC's most striking lakes — turquoise water ringed by glaciers and jagged peaks. Start by 7 AM, pack lunch. ~6 hrs roundtrip.

● Brandywine Falls 20 min south • Easy

BC's most dramatic roadside waterfall — 70m drop into a volcanic rock pool. 10-minute walk from parking. If the group needs a rest day from big hiking, this + Green Lake is a perfect half-day.

● Lost Lake Park + Green Lake

Relaxed afternoon

Lost Lake: 7 km forest loop with a swimming dock, free and beautiful. Green Lake: emerald-coloured water, SUP and kayak rentals, great for a warm afternoon.

GARIBALDI VS. EASY DAY — PICK ONE

Garibaldi Lake is a full, strenuous day. If the group wants lower effort, do Brandywine Falls (30 min), Lost Lake loop (2 hrs), and Green Lake (1 hr) — equally beautiful, half the effort. Both options are excellent.

DAY

10

TUESDAY, AUGUST 27, 2026

Sea to Sky → Vancouver → Fly Out

125 km • ~2 hr + stops • Return SUV at YVR

● Drive Sea to Sky Highway — Hwy 99 South Morning

One of Canada's great drives. The road hugs Pacific fjord shoreline with the Coast Mountains rising straight up on the east side. Howe Sound opens dramatically south of Squamish.

● Shannon Falls Provincial Park Near Squamish • 10 min walk

BC's third-tallest waterfall at 335m — a curtain of water plunging onto a rocky base. Five-minute paved walk from the parking lot. Easy, dramatic, and free. Do not skip this one on the last day.

● Stawamus Chief viewpoint Adjacent to Shannon Falls

652m granite monolith — North America's second-largest granite face. Pull off for the view from the parking area. No hike needed for an excellent photo.

● Continue to Vancouver 30 min from Squamish

Through West Vancouver and into the city. If the flight is evening: drop bags, walk the Stanley Park Seawall (10 km flat loop), visit Granville Island Market, or just eat well in Yaletown.

● Return SUV at YVR + Fly Out Per flight schedule

YVR is well-signed for car returns. Allow 3 hrs before departure during peak August — rental return queues run long, and Canada customs/security adds time. Confirm one-way drop instructions with your rental company before Day 1.

SEA TO SKY TIP

The drive from Whistler to Vancouver is only 2 hrs non-stop. Shannon Falls + the Chief viewpoint add just 30–45 minutes. Do both — they're adjacent and the waterfall is one of the finest quick stops on the entire trip.

QUICK REFERENCE

Must-See Highlights + Trip Tips

Moraine Lake

Valley of Ten Peaks — electric blue glacial water backed by ten mountains above 3,000m. The Rock Pile viewpoint is mandatory. Go at sunrise for the shot.

Lake Louise

Victoria Glacier reflection, Château backdrop, and the Lake Agnes Tea House hike (7.4 km rt). One of the Rockies' most complete destinations.

Peyto Lake

Wolf-head shaped viewpoint from Bow Summit. The most photographed lake in Alberta — a 20-minute walk from the highway that pays back ten-fold.

Columbia Icefield

Walk on the Athabasca Glacier + Glacier Skywalk glass platform. One of the most accessible glaciers in North America. Both covered by Pursuit Pass.

Maligne Lake

Spirit Island boat cruise — the glacier-framed island is one of the most reproduced landscape photos in Canada. Book the cruise months in advance for August.

Sea to Sky Hwy

Shannon Falls + Stawamus Chief + Howe Sound fjord coastline. The perfect finale. Two hours from Whistler to Vancouver with scenery the whole way.

PARKS CANADA DISCOVERY PASS

Required for Banff, Jasper & Glacier National Parks. Buy at parks.canada.ca. Group pass available. Covers all three parks on this trip — don't pay per-entry each day.

PURSUIT PASS COVERAGE

Confirm your specific Pursuit package before going. Standard coverage: Banff Gondola, Glacier Skywalk + Athabasca Glacier Walk, Peak 2 Peak Gondola in Whistler.

BEAR SAFETY ON EVERY TRAIL

Carry bear spray and know how to use it. Keep 100m from bears and wolves, 30m from elk and deer. In Jasper, elk walk in town — give them room and don't approach.

PRE-TRIP BOOKING CHECKLIST

Moraine Lake shuttle · Spirit Island cruise · Gondola reservations · All 4 Airbnbs/hotels · SUV one-way drop confirmed · Parks Canada Discovery Pass

AUGUST WEATHER + PACKING

Warm days (15–25°C), long daylight, wildflowers in bloom, all roads open. Evening temperatures

WHAT'S INCLUDED IN THIS TRIP

Pursuit Pass (gondola + icefield attractions) · SUV one-way rental YYC → YVR · 4

drop quickly in the mountains. Pack a shell jacket, layers, and sunscreen. Rain possible any day.

accommodation bases · Parks Canada Discovery Pass · All driving on paved roads